

Company: Mahindra Finance
Job Profile: Data Engineer
Offer Type: Placement Only
Internship Stipend: NA
CTC: 16 (14 Base+2 bonus)
Location: Mumbai(Kurla mostly)
Process Date: 3rd October,2025

Placement Process:

The eligibility criteria required a minimum of **6.0 CGPA** in college and **60% marks in both 10th and 12th**

1. **[Aptitude Round]** [All students from Comps,AIML,DS and having minor in computers from EXTC were eligible for the process]

The **Aptitude Round** consisted of 100 questions covering **Quantitative Aptitude, Geometry, Verbal Ability, and Logical Reasoning** to be solved in 1 hour. The quantitative section included problems on percentages, ratios, time and work, and geometry-based questions. The verbal section tested grammar, reading comprehension, and vocabulary, while the reasoning section focused on analytical thinking. In addition to these, there were a few **behavioral and situational questions** such as *“If your team member isn’t contributing effectively, what would you do?”* to assess decision-making and teamwork skills. Overall, the round focused on both technical and behavioral assessment.

This round followed a +4 -1 marking scheme so make sure to attempt the questions you are fully sure about, I managed to solve 94 questions. Since navigation was allowed,I quickly solved logical verbal and behavioral questions in the first 20 minutes and then proceeded to do the aptitude questions.

I practiced **Quantitative, Logical, and Verbal Aptitude** questions from **IndiaBix**, and most importantly taking their timed tests greatly helped me improve my speed and time management skills, which play a crucial role in performing well in aptitude exams.

2. **[Coding Round]** [72 candidates were shortlisted for this round]

Round 2 consisted of two sections – the first focused on basic Python MCQs, while the second included easy-level coding questions similar to those found on LeetCode. The only programming language allowed was Python. I was able to solve all the coding questions and pass all the test cases, along with answering almost all the MCQs correctly. This round was quite doable, and the key differentiator turned out to be time . Candidates who managed to solve almost all questions accurately and submitted their test about 15 minutes early were the ones who proceeded to the next round.

but since only allowed programming language was python and my primary language was Java, I practiced some basic questions from this youtube channel.

<https://youtu.be/78FsbjYSWIU?si=ehBIXHc3uNnGOLEF>

This has around 100 coding questions which will give you a strong grasp of the basics

For other DSA rounds, Practice Striver's sheet being well versed with it will help you clear DSA coding rounds of almost all the companies.

I practiced python mcqs from Sanfoundry (It has 1000 mcqs but to be able to be quick with mcqs that much of practice will really be worth it as you would have seen or solved all the questions in the past).

3. **[Group Discussion Round]** [25 candidates were shortlisted for this round]

The topic given to us was "Technology: Boon or Bane." Candidates who expressed their points in a clear, concise, and professional manner, speaking confidently and with good articulation, were the ones selected for the next round.

4. **[Technical Interview]** [11 students were selected for this round]

The interview was primarily focused on Python and Machine Learning. The interviewer was very particular about the answers and often went into detailed discussions. He began by asking me to introduce myself. Since I had researched Mahindra Finance beforehand, I knew that one of its key sectors deals with loan approval, which aligned well with my credit risk modelling project. I mentioned this connection during my introduction, which led him to ask several project-related questions.

He asked which algorithm I had used, and since I had applied SMOTE during preprocessing, he asked me to explain SMOTE along with its advantages and disadvantages. He then asked me to draw and explain the working of Random Forest and justify why it performed better than XGBoost in my case.

Next, he moved on to questions about my dataset. My project involved two datasets that I had merged, so he asked me to write the pandas query for merging them using the ID column as the key. He further asked detailed questions about the types of columns in my dataset and their relevance.

The discussion then shifted to model evaluation metrics, where he asked me to explain precision, recall, and accuracy, and to justify which metric mattered the most in my project context.

After that, he presented a case study scenario: "If Uber ride prices suddenly increase from ₹400 to ₹800 within 10 minutes in the same location, how would you identify and fix the bug in your ML model?" He asked me to describe the parameters and features I would use in such a model. He then gave another scenario: "If all drivers in a certain area stop accepting Uber rides and instead take private trips, how would your model detect such behavior?" I explained my approach, mentioning that one of the parameters would be peak-hour timings. He further asked how I would determine peak hours without having an existing dataset.

The interview concluded with me asking him three questions about Mahindra Finance's advancements in Machine Learning and how the company is integrating AI into its operations. Overall, it was a highly engaging and technical discussion that tested both conceptual understanding and practical problem-solving.

5.[HR Round]

The HR round surprisingly lasted for around 45 minutes, during which the HR was noting down my answers carefully. The discussion mainly revolved around situational and behavioral questions. I was given several case-based scenarios such as how I would handle a situation where a team member is not contributing effectively, or how I would respond if I witnessed something wrong happening around me. The HR wanted to understand my thought process, decision-making, and ability to handle real-life workplace challenges. Overall, it was a situational round focused on assessing attitude, ethics, and teamwork rather than technical knowledge.

Finally 5 students were selected :)

Useful Tips:

Focus on your CGPA. During our time, many companies had a **minimum CGPA criteria of 7.5**, which led to a large number of students being filtered out even before getting the opportunity to sit for the company. It really hurts when you don't even get the chance to appear despite having the skills.

Placements are a **tiring yet humbling process**. I had reached the HR rounds of **InCred** and **Quantiphi** before this opportunity, and both interviews went really well, but I couldn't make it to the final shortlist. That's when I truly realised how important factors like **CGPA and luck** can be in the placement journey. Sometimes, even after giving your best, things don't work out—but they prepare you for the opportunity that's meant for you.

My personal suggestion would be **during your 6th semester, shut out the noise around you and just believe in your hard work**. When your day finally comes, everything will start to make sense, you'll realise why you weren't selected earlier and how it was all just a testing phase before something bigger. Having your family and supportive friends around you truly encourages you to not get carried away by rejections and prepare for upcoming companies.

Study everything that's commonly asked in interviews. In placements, being a **jack of all trades** often works better than excelling in just one domain. Practicing **DSA** is important, of course, but relying only on it won't help much—only 4–5 companies are heavily DSA-focused and I realized it much much later. The rest mostly have **doable coding questions** in their online assessments and give high importance to **aptitude**, which most students tend to ignore.

For interviews, **know your resume inside out**—every project, every line. **SQL is the underdog** in placements, so make sure to practice it thoroughly beforehand.

When it comes to projects, **having a simple project that you understand deeply** is far better than having an overly complex one that you can't explain properly. Lastly, know your **OS, CN, and DBMS concepts** really well—many companies ask questions from these subjects. End-moment preparation won't help much here, so start early. I'd recommend watching **CodeHelp's OS playlist**, which is around 30 hours long—it's a time investment that's truly worth it.

All the very best for your placements! Give your best, trust the process, and have faith in your hard work. Everything will fall into place when it's meant to. God does have a plan for all 😊

For any queries or doubts:

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